



Fredrik Pahlman

LEAD DESIGNER · IC + LEADERSHIP ·
CRAFT · DISCOVERY · SYSTEMS

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Senior product designer and design lead with 12+ years delivering complex digital products end-to-end, from user research through to polished, production-ready UI. Equally comfortable as a strong individual contributor and as a team lead, with recent hands-on work spanning AI-assisted design, motion, and tight user testing on a consumer app at scale. Uses research and analytics to drive measurable improvements in usability and conversion, and brings a consistent bias for craft quality throughout.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Hands-on Product Design	End-to-end Delivery	Team Leadership & Mentoring
Design System Ownership	Cross-platform Consistency	B2C & B2B UX
Discovery & Research	Conversion & Usability	Cross-functional Alignment
Design Craft & Quality	AI-enabled Workflows	Ambiguity Navigation

EXPERIENCE

UX & Discovery Lead · Senior Product Designer

Oct 2024, Present

SLEEP CYCLE · Consumer health app · 40 people · Gothenburg

- Worked as a product designer embedded in the activation team with full end-to-end responsibility, from discovery through to polished, production-ready UI deliverables on a consumer app used by millions.
- Combined AI-assisted design and motion design to produce high-quality, animated UI that raised the bar on craft and feel, tested rigorously with real users throughout.
- Ran tight user testing loops across activation flows, using qualitative insight and behavioural signals to iterate quickly and drive measurable improvements in engagement and conversion.
- Took on the additional scope of UX and Discovery Lead across four product teams, building a continuous discovery practice with an unbroken 18-month weekly interview cadence, while

maintaining full IC responsibilities in the activation team.

- Integrated AI tools into synthesis, critique, and motion workflows throughout, treating them as a way to raise quality and speed simultaneously rather than reduce effort.

Head of Product · VP of UX · UX Designer

Feb 2020, Oct 2024

CARBONCLOUD · Climate tech B2B SaaS · Grew 10 to 45 people · Gothenburg

- Joined as the first design hire at 10 people and owned the end-to-end UX of a complex B2B data platform from day one, conducting research, defining interaction patterns, and shipping in close collaboration with engineering.
- Established the design foundation, component library, and UX principles that scaled as the product and team grew to 45 people.
- Progressed to Head of Product, leading product strategy, roadmapping, and a product team of three while maintaining close involvement in design quality and execution.
- Translated complex business and technical constraints into clear, structured user journeys across multiple user types and workflows.

Chief Design Officer · UX Director · Interaction Designer

Nov 2012, Feb 2020

INUSE · Design & innovation consultancy · Gothenburg

- Grew from practitioner to CDO over eight years, leading a 120-person design organisation across five Design Directors, setting craft standards and ensuring delivery quality across the firm.
- As UX Director and senior IC, led design on complex client products including medical devices, enterprise tools, and consumer-facing platforms, with direct responsibility for interaction quality and design system coherence across projects.
- Ran skills-based recruitment, structured competence sharing between designers, and assignment processes that balanced individual growth with consistent delivery quality as the firm scaled from 60 to 120 people.
- Senior project work for AstraZeneca and early-career work at Volvo Cars provided deep experience navigating design within technically complex, multi-stakeholder environments.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

IC CRAFT AT CONSUMER SCALE

As product designer in Sleep Cycle's activation team, delivered end-to-end UI design combining AI-assisted workflows, motion design, and continuous user testing, producing polished deliverables for a consumer product used by millions.

CONTINUOUS DISCOVERY PRACTICE

Built and sustained an 18-month unbroken weekly discovery cadence at Sleep Cycle across four product teams, making user insight a reliable and structured input to design and product decisions.

DESIGN QUALITY AT SCALE

At inUse CDO, maintained craft and consistency across a 120-person design organisation by introducing skills-based recruitment testing, structured competence sharing, and quality-focused assignment processes.

RESEARCH-DRIVEN IMPROVEMENTS

Combined qualitative discovery and behavioural signals at Sleep Cycle to identify high-impact usability and conversion opportunities, shortening the loop from user insight to shipped improvement.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Industrial Design Engineering · Chalmers University of Technology · Minor in Cognitive Ergonomics 2005 – 2010

TOOLS & METHODS

DESIGN & CRAFT

Figma, Midjourney, Miro, prototyping, component libraries, design systems

DISCOVERY & RESEARCH

Continuous Discovery, JTBD, Genway, Userology, Notion, qual & quant methods

AI & WORKFLOW

Claude, ChatGPT, Notion AI, AI-assisted synthesis & critique